



An insect's POV

A research team at the University of Illinois have created a camera that views the world from an insect's point of view <http://dgit.in/18KxdGc>

More iPhone 5S

Golden variant selling out faster than expected, Apple set to raise production by 33% <http://dgit.in/16kF9xV>

have a comfortable gaming experience. The overall performance of the tablet was quite good especially after the OS update. Swiping between apps, browsing the Internet, was a good experience. Overall, and more so because of the OS update, this tablet gave us good overall performance. Typing on and the response of the touch-screen too are good.

The Ceros Revolution Tablet 9.7 runs on Android 4.2 Jelly Bean and has a few preloaded UI elements. The tablet is relatively smooth when swiping on the display or in the apps listing page, but we have seen it lag during multitasking. Videos and games



Zync Quad 10.1

ran smoothly on the tablet and its real world performance is at par with the iBerry Auxus Core X4 3G tablet. A graphically heavy game like Real Racing 3 ran on the tablet but there were some serious frame rate issues. A physical volume rocker is missed on the tablet. While playing Dead Trigger we needed to reduce the volume, but didn't know which of the five dots at the bottom of the display was the volume control (the controls becomes dots when you are in an app) and ended up going to the home screen or pressing the multitasking button. This isn't a big deal, but it does hamper your user experience.

The Huawei MediaPad 10 Link runs on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean and Huawei has its own custom Emotion UI overlaying the OS. It is the only tablet in the shootout to have a custom UI. The first thing that you will notice about the UI is that you don't have the standard apps and widgets listing page that we are used to seeing on all other Android tablets. Instead you have all the apps listed on the home screens, something we are used to seeing on iOS. You can also stack them into folders depending on your requirement.

When customizing the home screen with widgets, the bottom half of the Huawei MediaPad 10

Link's display has the widgets and the top half has the home screens making the interface quite seamless. To access the widgets all you need to do is long press on the home screen.

Taking a look at the real world performance of the Huawei MediaPad 10 Link, it is quite good. Browsing the internet, playing games, watching movies and interacting with the touchscreen was good. The MediaPad 10 Link also has the ability to house a SIM card for data only. The tablet can't make calls. The audio output from the speakers is really loud. There are two speakers that are housed at the back of the tablet and the MediaPad 10 link also boasts of Dolby Digital Plus. You have the option to switch this off, use it in movie or music mode. For its price, the performance on offer in the MediaPad 10 Link is good.

The biggest advantage of owning a Nexus device is that

you are the first to receive the Android OS update. The raw Android experience is the smoothest there is. Coming to the first generation Nexus 7, the tablet's performance has improved significantly ever since the Android 4.3 update. Its benchmark scores have however remained the same. The interface of the tablet is the smoothest there is and all the apps and games ran very well. The performance of the display is a bit underwhelming when it comes to the reproduction of colours and the viewing angles. Playing games, watching movies and more was a treat on the tablet, but the audio from the built in speaker was lower than we'd like. Another disadvantage is that the tablet doesn't support expandable storage.

Last but not least, we have the second generation Nexus and boy-o-boy is this tablet a treat to use. Starting with the touch screen, it responds to a feather touch. Typing on the device, especially in portrait mode is very comfortable. The display is vibrant, gorgeous and has the best col-

Simtronics XPAD Mini



our reproduction and viewing angles of the lot. All the games, apps and videos we played on the tablet ran smoothly and without any hiccups. There was a time when the device was circulated between a few of us in the lab and we were all impressed with the overall multi-tasking.

Quite a few apps on the tablet had been switched on and the interface was still smooth. Even in the benchmark scores, the second generation Nexus 7 left the competition way behind. The audio output from the speakers too has improved when compared to the previous generation Nexus tablet. The stereo speakers also give a good effect of channel shift. This is more evident when watching action movies. The battery life of the tablet too is one of the best. In



Nexus 7 (First generation)